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New law to govern national school curriculum issued

CLEAR FRAMEWORK SET FOR SCHOOLS FROM KG TO GRADE 12

ABU DHABI
Gulf News Report

The UAE Government has taken a major step to strengthen its education system by issuing a Federal Decree Law on the Governance of the National Educational Curriculum. For the first time, the law provides a comprehensive framework regulating how the curriculum is designed, approved, implemented, and reviewed across the country.

The decree sets out an integrated governance system, clearly defining the roles and responsibilities of federal and local authorities. It aims to ensure effective coordination, transparency, accountability, and community participation in shaping the nation's educational programmes.

Stable and consistent

The law aims to maintain a stable and consistent national curriculum while allowing flexibility to adapt to future developments, societal needs and labour market demands.

By doing so, it seeks to enhance the quality of education, strengthen the competitiveness

CHANGES DIVIDED INTO FOUR CATEGORIES

- Fundamental:** Major revisions affecting the philosophical or structural foundations of the curriculum, approved by the Education, Human Resources, and Community Development Council and ratified by the Council of Ministers, following piloting and evaluation.
- Partial:** Limited changes to specific subjects or topics, approved by the Education Council.
- Technical:** Adjustments for clarity, formatting, or presentation, approved by the Ministry of Education.
- Exceptional:** Urgent updates in response to national or global emergencies, approved by the Education Council and reported to the Council of Ministers if wide-ranging.

of the sector, and prepare students to integrate effectively into both local and global economies.

The provisions apply to all public and private schools following the national curriculum, from kindergarten to Grade 12. They also extend to private schools that do not follow the national curriculum, requiring them to teach approved compulsory subjects to ensure a shared educational foundation and reinforce national identity and values.

The decree identifies the UAE's National Education Charter as the supreme reference for education policy. The charter defines national education ob-

jectives, graduate competencies, societal values, national identity, and principles guiding curriculum design and development.

The decree outlines key curriculum components, including learning outcomes, teaching methods, educational pathways, language of instruction, course duration, and compulsory and elective subjects.

The decree also allows government, private, or non-profit entities, including those in free zones, to propose curriculum amendments backed by research demonstrating alignment with national education goals, labour market needs, and societal values.



Virendra Saklani/Gulf News

HAMDAN PRESENTS LIFETIME ACHIEVEMENT AWARD TO DJOKOVIC

Sheikh Hamdan Bin Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Crown Prince of Dubai, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Defence of the UAE, and Chairman of Dubai Executive Council, presents the Global Lifetime Achievement award to Serbian tennis ace Novak Djokovic on the opening day of World Sports Summit in Dubai yesterday. **SEE ALSO P12**

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